INLS161-001 Spring 2024

Tools for Information Literacy

Syllabus

Q: What is INLS161-001 all about?

A: This is an information tools class, and is part of an information literacy curriculum.

According to the American Library Association, Information Literacy ...

> *... is related to information technology skills, but has broader implications for the individual, the educational system, and for society.*
> *Information technology skills enable an individual to use computers, software applications, databases, and other technologies to achieve a wide variety of academic, work-related, and personal goals.*
> *Information literate individuals necessarily develop some technology skills ...*

Increasingly, information technology skills are interwoven with, and support, information literacy.

EXPECTATIONS BACK TO TOP

A full information literacy curriculum would include:

1. Resource literacy - The ability to understand the form, format, location and access methods of information resources
2. Social-structural literacy - Knowledge of how information is socially situated and produced. It includes understanding the scholarly publishing process
3. Research literacy - The ability to understand and use information technology tools to carry our research including discipline-related software
4. Publishing literacy - The ability to produce a text or multimedia report of the results of research
5. TOOL LITERACY - THE ABILITY TO USE PRINT AND ELECTRONIC RESOURCES INCLUDING SOFTWARE

INFO LITERACY CONCEPTS AND TOOLS GOALS

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INLS161-001 will focus on CONCEPTS AND THE TOOLS needed to communicate your information to users.

We will begin with the building blocks of the Internet and the World Wide Web, to be certain we understand what the basic tools are doing for us. This will allow us to know how to create well-formed materials to be used on the Web.

We will also introduce concepts and practice skills germane to effective use of the power built into word processing, spreadsheet, and presentation graphics software. Although one may use either Google Workspace, or LibreOffice, or Open Office, or Microsoft Office 365 suites of applications for many tasks, the basic concepts should provide you with skills that will enable you to be comfortable with all similar packages.

Some of our goals for the semester include:

Ability to use the Internet effectively

1. become familiar with the Internet and its basic tools
2. be able to use some basic command-line instructions (using either UNIX or LINUX, or both) and to understand the Secure File Transfer Protocol
3. become conversant with the term OPEN SOURCE - some of its applications, its promise and its limitations

Ability to create useful Web content

1. understand the basic tools underlying the web
2. be able to create web pages by using basic HTML, basic CSS, and basic server-side and client-side scripting

Ability to effectively format written documents

1. understand the underlying power of markup languages in document creation software programs
2. be able to format documents for publication

Ability to effectively use spreadsheets

1. understand the vector power of functions in spreadsheet applications
2. be able to format spreadsheets for professional usages
3. begin the transition from flat file to relational databases
   by understanding the basic Entity Relationship Model terminology
   and being able to do basic Structured Query Language queries

1. understand the power of visual language and design
2. be able to design and deliver effective audio/visual presentations

INFO LITERACY CONCEPTS AND TOOLS GOALS

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Expectations

ALL WORK DONE IN INLS161-001 WILL BE DONE ON YOUR PERSONAL COMPUTER

There will be no paper products generated in this class and there is no printing requirement. You will be well served to bring your laptops with you to every lecture and every recitation session.

ONE LIMITATION

No one is permitted to record any of the class sessions, either with video or audio recorders, unless you first discuss it with the instructor and receive written permission to do so.

However, each Zoom session will be recorded for those who, for any reason, are unable to be with us synchronously. The link to the stored recordings will be available in Canvas.

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